Planning and Development Department
Current Planning Division
Landmarks Preservation Commission

NOTICE OF DECISION
FOR MEETING OF: May 6, 2002

PROPERTY ADDRESSES AND OWNERS:	1508 La Loma Avenue, Katherine Bishop Dunlap 1509 La Loma Avenue, Ivan and Maris Meyerson 1512 La Loma Avenue, Louise Anderson 1514 La Loma Avenue, Helen Christensen 1515 La Loma Avenue, Nancy and Tom Genn 1521 La Loma Avenue, Beth Simmons and Bruce Jackan 1525 La Loma Avenue, Kenton and Kuniko King 1530 La Loma Avenue, William and Beverly Bouwsma 1542 La Loma Avenue, David Bigham and Howard Arendtson 1544 La Loma Avenue, David Bigham and Howard Arendtson 2678 Buena Vista Way, Tamar Sanbor 2704 Buena Vista Way, Thomas Smith 1581 LeRoy Avenue, Berkeley Unified School District
ALSO KNOWN AS:	La Loma Park Historic District
ACTION:	Historic District Designation
DESIGNATION AUTHORS:	Monica Rohrer, 1508 La Loma Avenue Nancy Genn and Bruce Brubaker, 1509 La Loma Avenue Monica Rohrer, 1512 La Loma Avenue Monica Rohrer, 1514 La Loma Avenue Nancy Genn and Bruce Brubaker, 1515 La Loma Avenue Sally Wages, 1521 La Loma Avenue Sally Wages, 1525 La Loma Avenue Nancy Genn, 1530 La Loma Avenue David Bigham and Nancy Genn, 1542 La Loma Avenue David Bigham and Nancy Genn, 1544 La Loma Avenue Monica Rohrer, 2678 Buena Vista Way Sally Wages, 2704 Buena Vista Way Monica Rohrer, 1581 Le Roy Avenue

WHEREAS, on January 7, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission initiated for landmark designation and set for Public Hearing on March 4, 2002 the La Loma Park Historic District to include the following properties: 1508, 1509, 1512, 1514, 1515, 1521, 1525, 1530, 1542, 1544, La Loma Avenue, and 2678 and 2704 Buena Vista Way;

WHEREAS, on March 4, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission opened the public hearing and without taking testimony continued the public hearing to April 8, 2002;

WHEREAS, on April 8, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission held a public hearing and took public testimony to consider a proposed designation for the La Loma Park Historic District. The Landmarks Preservation Commission then continued the public hearing until May 6, 2002 to allow for further discovery and documentation;

WHEREAS, on April 8, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission initiated 1581 LeRoy Avenue, Hillside School for landmark designation adding it to the list of initiated properties as part of the La Loma Park Historic District;

WHEREAS, on April 26, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission published a new public hearing notice that included 1581 Le Roy Avenue;

WHEREAS, on May 6, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission continued the public hearing to consider a proposed designation for La Loma Park Historic District;

WHEREAS, on May 6, 2002, the Landmarks Preservation Commission found that the properties on both sides of the segment of La Loma Avenue between Buena Vista Way and La Verada Road the "La Loma Park Historic District." The District is comprised of the following contiguous properties: 2704 Buena Vista, 1509 La Loma, 1515 La Loma, 1521 La Loma, 1525 La Loma, 1542 and 1544 La Loma, 1530 La Loma, 1581 Le Roy Avenue, 1514 La Loma, 1512 La Loma, 1508 La Loma, and 2678 Buena Vista Way. The "La Loma Park Historic District" derives its name from Captain Richard Parks Thomas' 32-acre, 19th century farm, in which these homes are now located, and are worthy as a historic district for the following reasons:

Statement of Significance – Historic District:

The homes in the La Loma Park Historic District, built between 1908 and 1940, provide a visual history of the main currents of architectural developments of that period. From Viennese Secession to International Modern influenced design, the range of different architectural styles reflects the spirit of creative, revolutionary experiment that inspired Berkeley architects in the first half of the twentieth century. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of periods, styles, architectural movements or construction...")***

Most of the homes in the La Loma Park Historic District were designed by major architects including Bernard Maybeck (1864-1954), Ernest Coxhead (1863- 1933), John K. Ballantine, Jr. (1894- 1969), Walter H. Ratcliff, Jr. (1881- 1973), Warren Perry (1884- 1980), Roland Irving Stringham (1892- 1954), and Oskar Gerson (1886- 1966). ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: ...examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder.")***

The homes in the La Loma Park Historic District all reflect, to varying degrees, a distinctive Berkeley approach to the revolution in architecture sweeping across Europe and America, rooted in the Hillside Club discussions and the architectural philosophy articulated by Berkeley resident, poet, and naturalist, Charles Keeler (1871- 1937). This philosophy advocated rejection of the contemporary urban lifestyle and a return to the simple life with more time to enjoy nature, the arts, and family; the use of natural materials in construction; the use of the rhythm of structural elements to inform the decoration of the interior; reflection on pre-industrial European architecture and vernacular architecture from around the world; and, most important, the belief that homes should not detract from the beauty of nature but should sit with harmony in it. The La Loma Park Historic District homes were all sited to take advantage of the light, view, and natural beauty around them. La Loma Avenue follows the curve of the hill's contours, providing superb western and southern views for the residences. The irregular siting of homes in relation to the street lends visual interest and provides a contrast to the grid system used in the flat western section of Berkeley. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

The properties in the La Loma Park Historic District represent a major aspect of Berkeley's social history. Complementing the Delaware Street Historical District, which preserves an early commercial Town neighborhood, this block of La Loma is representative of the "Gown" component of Berkeley Society. It has consistently been a preferred site for the residences of academics, including nationally famous figures geologist Andrew Lawson (1861- 1952), discoverer of the San Andreas fault; the pioneer woman scientist, Dr. Katharine Bishop (1889-1975), co-discoverer of Vitamin E; and Alexander Meiklejohn (1872-1964), the well-known advocate of freedom of speech as the guarantor of democratic government. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Statements of significance for the individual properties follows on pages 3-14:

2704 Buena Vista – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Mathewson House
Bernard Maybeck, 1916
First San Francisco Bay Tradition
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
The Mathewson House, designed by Bernard Maybeck in 1915, is virtually a textbook illustration of the architectural philosophy articulated by Berkeley resident poet, and naturalist, Charles Keeler (1871-1937). The residence exemplifies Keeler's and the Hillside Club's philosophy that houses should not detract from the beauty of nature, but should fit into it. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

This house is the classic example of Maybeck's "small house" ideas, a simple, austere, remarkable piece of spatial compaction, yet a superbly landscaped design, which was a low budget house at the time it was built. The simple massing and broad low lines of the house, with its overhanging eaves and protruding beam ends, as well as its glass walls, clearly shows the influence of Japanese architecture on Maybeck. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: ...examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder.")***

The house is very important in its neighborhood context as being one of a cluster of houses, which Maybeck designed on his own property. It is the only pre-1923 fire example in this group. Maybeck's daughter Kerna reportedly saved the house from the flames by wetting down its roof.

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	**Significant Structural Features**	**Significant Landscape Features**
Bernard Maybeck 1916 First San Francisco Bay Tradition	Simple massing and compact size; Broad, low rooflines; Large overhanging eaves, Brackets and protruding beam ends; Stained green board and batten siding; Multi-light wood doors, and windows; Butterfly bay roof; Concrete chimney; Decorative vent pipe on roof; First floor rough stucco finish; Original exterior light fixtures	Designation includes landscape; Site only

1509 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Rowell House
Masten and Hurd, 1930
English Tudor Revival
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
Built in 1930, and designed by the San Francisco architectural firm Masten and Hurd, the Rowell House is a good example of English Tudor Revival architecture. It adds a distinctive quality to the street not only in the design of the house but the garden setting. The beautifully landscaped grounds add an air of elegance to the neighborhood. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are ... outstanding examples of architectural styles...")***

The house was built by Elmer Rowell, a partner in Mason-McDuffie, the real estate firm that developed tracts of distinctive homes such as the St. Francis Wood District in San Francisco. Having had Masten and Hurd design the St. Francis Wood homes in San Francisco, it was natural for Mr. Rowell to have the firm also design his own distinctive residence in Berkeley.

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	**Significant Structural Features**	**Significant Landscape Features**
Masten and Hurd 1930 English Tudor Revival	Tall steeped red brick chimney with stacks dominating the front façade; Second smaller brick chimney; Steeply sloped roof covered in English shingle tile; Prominent front facing gable and intersecting hip roof; Heavy wood molding under, and vent in, gable; Carved, paneled, recessed oak entry door with heavy hammered nails; Six over six lighted wood sash windows; Leaded glass/diamond paned windows; Deeply inset windows; North dormer; Half-arch window to left of front chimney; Copper decorative gutters with ornament; Garage w/ upstairs cottage; Brickwork and half timbering detail;	Designation includes site and landscaped front garden; significant features include front stone walkway and retaining wall.

1515 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Lawson House
Bernard Maybeck, 1907-1908
Viennese Secession Influence
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria, National Register Eligible

Statement of Significance:
The Lawson house was built for Andrew Lawson, one of America's greatest geologists and the man who first mapped the San Andreas Fault. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Because of Lawson's awareness of earthquake risks, he asked Bernard Maybeck to design an earthquake resistant and fireproof structure. Maybeck obliged with a pioneering use of reinforced concrete in residential design. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: ...examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder." BMC 3.24.110.A.5. "Any property which is ...eligible for listing on the National Register.")***

The building's style is an expression of its material, being reminiscent of a Roman villa and tinted like Mediterranean houses. However, the home also has a Viennese Secession influence as evidenced in the inscribed geometric patterns and the glass tile detail on the exterior.

Maybeck adapted the contemporary European style of the society of revolutionary artists and architects who had seceded from the Viennese establishment. With its rejection of traditional ornament, smooth surfaces, and rhythmic arrangement of simple geometric volumes, Viennese Secession architecture was a pre-cursor of the International Style modern architecture of the 1920s. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of...styles, architectural movements.")***

The Lawson house was designed to take advantage of the light, view, and natural beauty of the site. The long rectangular building repeats the projecting line of the hillside. Main reception rooms and bedrooms with large expanses of windows open onto the sunny south side. Gardens also surround the house predominantly on this long southern view-side. The pergolas show Maybeck's concern for integrating the structure with nature, extending it out into space and inviting the growth of vines. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	Significant Structural Features	Landscape Features
Bernard Maybeck 1907-1908 Viennese Secession Influence	Early reinforced concrete construction; Concrete slab roof with low pitch; Tinted stucco surface enriched with graffito design (east side), scoring, and inset colored tiles; Pergolas and associated pavilion with Doric entablature; South facing ground floor terrace; South facing upstairs loggia-sleeping porch; Curved south facing balcony with decorative iron railing; Glass doors which open to the outdoors on the south side; Mix of rectangular, round and arched deeply recessed windows; Small circular vent holes into pantry for cooling; Recessed door and arched front entry; Leaded glass window over front entry; Shallow niche with low pitched overhang to left of front entry; Concrete chimney with low pitched roof top; Garage is not contributing.	Designation includes landscape with a focus on the integration of site and structure. Significant features identified are the Pergola, which encloses two sides of the rear yard, and the stacked stick tresses cantilevered from pilasters around the building's perimeter. Also significant are the curved driveway, the stone pathways, and the concrete retaining wall at the southern end of the property.

1521 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Walton House
Oskar Gerson, 1940
Second Phase San Francisco Bay Tradition, influenced by International Style/Modern
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
The Walton House property is architecturally significant because it illustrates the extraordinary impact of the regional Bay Area tradition of architecture on a highly accomplished European architect who had been a revolutionary in his original environment.

Oskar Gerson had been one of the principals in the architectural firm of Gerson Brothers, which had received numerous major commissions for skyscraper buildings in downtown Hamburg in the 1920s. They developed their own regional style which neither followed the International Style modern of the Bauhaus, with its emphasis on glass and steel, nor the fantastic expressionism of the fellow Hamburg architect, Fritz Hoeger, in his 1923 Chilehaus. Rather they focused on new ways to use the traditional material of brick and traditional sculptural subjects.

In designing the Walton house at the age of 54, Gerson had so quickly absorbed the principles of the Bay area tradition in its second phase led by William Wurster. Here he had to design for hillside rather than a level site, in wood rather than brick, for a warm rather than a cold climate. In both Hamburg and Berkeley, Gerson demonstrated an extraordinary sensitivity to the demands of the environment. Thus, the Walton house is significant as the first Californian creation of a revolutionary European searching for new architectural solutions. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: ...examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder." BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	Significant Structural Features	Landscape Features
Oskar Gerson 1940 Second Phase San Francisco Bay Tradition, influenced by International Style Modern	T-shape; Modest character with careful siting related to view; Low-pitched, hip roof with a broad overhang; Stucco façade; Trellis/balcony over garage entrance; Wrap-around corner wood sash windows; Large expansive windows, including French doors; Wood and glass doors; Original front light fixture; Smooth brick chimney; Shake roof	Designation includes landscape. Significant features include: exterior front cut stone steps, cut and natural volcanic stone retaining walls, slate driveway, patio plan.

1525 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Wells House
Roland Irving Stringham, 1922 – 1923
English Arts and Crafts
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
A survivor of the September 1923 fire, the Wells House, an English Arts and Crafts style home, is an early example of the shift in Berkeley taste away from the First Bay Tradition and brown shingles towards revival styles and stucco. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are ... outstanding examples of architectural styles...")***

The influence of Berkeley Hillside ideals is evidenced in a sleeping porch tucked into the roof at the southern end of the south wing. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

The house is an early work of the major Berkeley architect, Roland Irving Stringham (1892-1954), elected member of the American Institute of Architects in 1927. Stringham's designs include the Berkeley Tennis Club (1917) at One Tunnel Road. He was later known for his houses in a Mediterranean (Spanish revival) style, such as the Berkeley residence for Henry Swift, which was given an N.C.C. AIA honor award in May 1927. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: ...examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder.")***

From 1935 until his death in 1964, this was the home of Alexander Meiklejohn, a major Berkeley beacon of liberal thought around the world. Meiklejohn (1872-1964), a brilliant and multi-faceted intellect, was a figure of national and international importance for his innovations in higher education and political thought. After receiving a B.A. from Brown University in Rhode Island in 1893 and a Ph.D. from Cornell in 1897, he returned to Brown to teach until 1912 when he was appointed president of Amherst College, Massachusetts. Dismissed from Amherst in June 1923 for his controversial policies, in 1926 he joined the faculty of the University of Wisconsin, where he founded the Experimental College. In addition to this advocacy and implementation of revolutionary changes in higher education, from 1948 until his death in 1964, he wrote and spoke on the importance of freedom of speech under the First Amendment as the protector of democratic government. His widow, Helen, continued their joint active support of the American Civil Liberties Union of California. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	**Significant Structural Features**	**Landscape Features**
Roland Irving Stringham 1922 – 1923 English Arts and Crafts	Composition of vertical rectangular masses; Steeply pitched rooflines; Hipped roofs and jerkinhead gable dormers Plain wall surfaces; Tall chimneys (one brick and one stucco with decorative chimney pots); Asymmetrical window locations; Multi-lighted windows (predominantly six over six lights with wood sash); Two Dominant front facing gables; Arched front entry with shed roof and detailing; Arched side entry with detailing; Stucco facade; Windows on three sides of south wing; Sleeping porch south end of south wing	Designation includes landscape; significant features include the site, the front terracing and front brick steps and the private patio with enclosing beds

1542 and 1544 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Tolman Cottages
James Mc Creery, 1925
First Bay Area Tradition Craftsman Versions
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
The Tolman Cottages, 1925, designed by architect James Mc Creery, are excellent examples of the First Phase Bay Area Tradition. The cottages were sited to take full advantage of the light, view, and topography of the site rather than to conform to the street shape. The pair adds interest to the street as well as a sense of joy and playfulness. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of...styles, architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

The cottages were built for Professor Edward Tolman, adjoining his residence at 1530 La Loma. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	**Significant Structural Features**	**Landscape Features**
James Mc Creery 1925 First Bay Area Tradition Craftsman Versions	Low-pitched roofs; Mineral-colored stucco and multi-colored stained redwood board and batten and "timbered" finishing, including chevron patterning; Tall, narrow multi-paned, wood sash casement windows; Decorative detailing on the ends of the gable boards; Decorative cut wood pieces below window sills; Wood and glass doors; Chimneys	Designation includes landscape; site only.

1530 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Tolman House
Warren Perry, 1924-1925
Spanish Colonial Revival
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
Designed by Warren Perry, chairman of the Architecture Department of the University of California, Berkeley, the Tolman House is a fine example of Spanish Colonial Revival style architecture. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are ... outstanding examples of architectural styles...or examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder.")***

It was built for Professor Edward Chace Tolman, a noted psychologist on the faculty of the University of California. In addition to prominence in his academic field, Professor Tolman is notable for his leadership in the 1949-1950 "Loyalty Oath" controversy within the University. He was one of the most distinguished of a group of professors who, basing their case on the principle of academic freedom, refused to sign an anti-communist oath imposed by the University's Board of Regents. More than 30 "non-signer" faculty, most at Berkeley, were ultimately fired but were later reinstated after they won a court order. The controversy, which drew national attention and shook the University of California, is chronicled in David Gardener's book, " The California Oath Controversy," and Professor George Stewart's book "The Year of the Oath." Tolman was perhaps the most prominent of the faculty to lose his job during the controversy, and his principled resistance tothe oath helped galvanize the opposition and his colleagues. Tolman was later honored by the University and Tolman Hall, housing the School of Education and Department of Psychology, was named for him in the 1960's. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	**Significant Structural Features**	**Landscape Features**
Warren Perry 1924-1925 Spanish Colonial Revival	Asymmetrical front façade; Two front facing gables, each symmetrically composed; Wood framed oriole window in the left-hand gable with scalloped wood decoration; Large 5-sided bay window in right-hand gable with wood sash, multi-paned casement windows; Deeply cut wall opening to the hand-crafted wood entry door; Inset heavy wood diamond paneled front entry door; Black iron light fixture mounted to heavy beam over the entry; Red mission tile roof with little eave overhang; Detail on rafters under the eaves; Rough hewn white stucco finish; Stucco chimney with a clay top; Small round stucco vents; Decorative stucco grillwork; Curved supports for cantilevered second floor overhang; Wood sash multi-paned windows; Garage integral to design of house because of adjoining stucco wall, stucco finish, matching detail on rafters under the eaves, large box beam over garage door.	Designation includes landscape; site only.

1581 LeRoy Avenue – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Hillside School
Walter H. Ratcliff, Jr., 1925
Tudor Revival
City of Berkeley Landmark, Listed on the National Register

Statement of Significance:
See Statement of Significance in the National Register Application for this property.

See National Register application for description of significant features to be preserved.

1514 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Weeks House
Architect unknown, 1926
Brown Shingle
Individually meets City of Berkeley Structure of Merit criteria

Statement of Significance:
The Weeks House contributes to the neighborhood as a straightforward example of the arts and crafts movement vernacular. ***(BMC 3.24.110.B.2.a. "The age of the structure is contemporary with (1) a designated landmark within its neighborhood, block, street frontage, or group of buildings, or (2) an historic period or event of significance to the City, or to the structure's neighborhood, block, street frontage, or group of buildings.")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	Significant Structural Features	Landscape Features
Architect unknown 1926 Brown Shingle	Decorative brickwork on chimney; Wood sash double hung and casement windows; Brown shingle façade; South facing bay window; Garage is not contributing	Designation includes landscape; site only

1512 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Ballantine House and Cottage
John K. Ballantine, Jr., 1924
English Cotswold Cottage Revival
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
The Ballantine House can be thought of as exemplifying both late-day aspects of the Bay Tradition in architecture coupled with the Hillside Club's philosophy of city planning and architecture and the later pragmatic necessity of recognizing and bowing to the destructive power of nature.

The influence of the tenets promulgated by Berkeley's prominent Hillside Club, which promoted the concept of "building in harmony with nature," is evident in the early 20th Century homes of northeast Berkeley. They are constructed of wood and other natural rustic materials that blend almost symbiotically with their surroundings. There is harmony between the structures and the natural landscape of their settings. While this architectural philosophy was still a factor in the early 1920's, after the 1923 Berkeley fire that ravaged much of the northeast area, architects, builders, and homeowners alike sought to rebuild with new and innovative materials that would be resistant to the ravages of fire in the future.

The Ballantine House was one of the first projects built in the recently fire-devastated northeast Berkeley. True to Hillside Club thinking and recognizing the properties powerful setting, J.K. Ballantine, Jr. designed as his 'ideal house' two structures at this site that are "in harmony with nature." The larger house is set back from the street at the far western border. It is oriented to take full advantage of the topography and light: there is sunlight for the house throughout the day and the splendor of the expansive view toward the Golden Gate is breathtaking. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

Together, the setting and the two structures are reminiscent of an old English village in miniature. A larger "family manse" that is the principal building is linked by a stone path to an "outbuilding," a small cottage across from the main house. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are ... outstanding examples of architectural styles...")***

The Ballantine house is also a powerful example of innovative materials used post-disaster to build fire-resistant (Ballantine specified "no oil paints") residences. The natural concrete was left exposed on the interior as well as the exterior. The slate roofing material it is told was reclaimed from the old St. Mary's College in Oakland. In addition, these materials contributed to the older precept of using "natural" materials. The concrete blocks simulate the stones used for the typical Cotswold Cottage. The slate materials were also used for roofs in Cotswold Cottages. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are... outstanding examples of... construction...")***

Berkeley is filled with structures of major historical and architectural value. The Ballantine House figures strongly among their number. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: ...examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder.")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	Significant Structural Features	Landscape Features
John K. Ballantine 1924 English Cotswold Cottage Revival	Steeply pitched slate roof with shallow eaves; Copper flashing with standing seams at roof ridgeline; Constructed of specially cast concrete bricks on interior and exterior, with a zinc alloy spacer; Unpainted concrete exterior intended to resemble stone; Hammered copper and Zinc gutters; Multi-paned leaded glass and stained glass windows; Recessed entry door with small leaded glass window, subtle carved arch, and dripstone hood moldings above; Light fixture; Stucco panel at rear of house which symbolizes architect/owner Ballantine's life; Brick chimneys; Rounded dormer; 1948 kitchen addition; Rear half-timbered addition; Decorative brickwork and half-timbering in cottage gable	Designation includes landscape. Significant features include the site, the stone pathway approaching the front door, and the path between the main house and outbuilding.

1508 La Loma – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Bishop House
Ernest Coxhead, 1923
Spanish Colonial Revival
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
Ernest Coxhead built two houses for the Tyndall and Katharine Bishop family on this site, the first of which was destroyed in the fire of 1923. The family engaged the architect to rebuild, with the provision that the structure be "fireproof." In his plan, Coxhead has been very conscious of the garden, and, by providing a profusion of windows, has opened up the interiors towards the out-of-doors. The architect was a close personal friend of his client and he lived with them at 1508 La Loma just prior to his death in 1933. He had created for his friends a residence that was a fine example of cleanly detailed, well-proportioned Spanish Colonial style architecture. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Architectural Merit: Properties that are ... outstanding examples of architectural styles...or examples of the more notable works of the best surviving work in a region of an architect, designer, or master builder.")***

Dr. Katharine Scott Bishop was a co-discoverer of vitamin E. She and Dr. Herbert Evans discovered the deficiency of the vitamin in 1922 and identified vitamin E in 1924. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	**Significant Structural Features**	**Landscape Features**
Ernest Coxhead 1923 Spanish Colonial Revival	Heavy red clay tile roofing; Two-story linear design front facade, broken by many windows; Simple but dignified treatment of the off-center arched main entrance; Multi-light wood sash casement windows; Stucco façade; Clean detail and good proportions overall; Front balcony with iron railing; Driveway post and inscription; Bay window, north side; Garage and gate are not contributing.	Designation includes landscape; Significant landscape features include the deep setback, flagstone paths, and the oak tree.

2678 Buena Vista – *Contributing Structure and Site*

Etcheverry House
John K. Ballantine, Jr. (not proven), 1924
Arts and Craft
Individually meets City of Berkeley Landmark criteria

Statement of Significance:
The Etcheverry house captures the Hillside Club movement of the natural landscape relationship to the home and is also an excellent example of the Arts and Crafts movement. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.1.b. "Properties that are prototypes of or outstanding examples of... architectural movements." BMC 3.24.110.A.2. "Structures, sites, and areas associated with the movement or evolution of... cultural developments of the City.")***

In the 1923 fire, the preexisting house at this site burned to the foundation. The present home was built as a response to the fire and therefore materials such as the stucco finish and the tile roof were chosen with the hope that it would be fireproof.

The home was built for Bernard Alfred and Helen Etcheverry. Bernard Etcheverry, a Civil Engineer, taught at the University of California, Berkeley, for 47 years. A Professor of Irrigation and Drainage, Etcheverry successfully mixed an outstanding academic and teaching career with a private engineering practice. Etcheverry was influential in formulating California water supply policy in a public as well as a private capacity, particularly with respect to the Central Valley. Etcheverry Hall on the UC Berkeley Campus is named for Alfred Etcheverry. ***(BMC 3.24.110.A.4. "Historic value: Preservation and enhancement of structures, sites, and areas that embody and express the history...of Berkeley. History may be social, cultural...")***

Significant features to be preserved include:

Architect, Year, & Style	Significant Structural Features	Landscape Features
John K. Ballantine, Jr. (not proven) 1924 Arts and Craft	Steeply-pitched roof with shallow eaves; Flat English style clay roof tiles; Large brick chimneys on the north and east sides; Front entrance with a recessed covered porch and overhang; Rough stucco façade with some vertical wood siding; Recessed detail at top of gable; Variety of windows, including large picture windows, multi-light casement windows, and double-hung windows; Wood bay window on south side with clay tile roof; Dormer on north side with board and wide batten siding; Arched rear porch; Stucco garage with decorative half-timbering in the gable is contributing; Rear artist's studio is not contributing;	Designation includes landscape. The significant feature is the natural garden on west side.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED that the La Loma Park Historic District which includes 1508, 1509, 1512, 1514, 1515, 1521, 1525, 1530, 1542, 1544, La Loma Avenue, 2678 and 2704 Buena Vista Way, and 1581 LeRoy Avenue is hereby designated a **City of Berkeley Historic District**

VOTE: 8-0-0-1

Aye: Edwards, Eichenfield, Emmington, Korte, Morse, Olson, O'Malley and Rohrer
Nay: None
Abstain: None
Absent: Dishnica

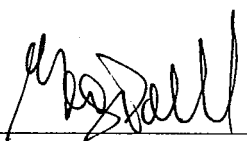
DATE NOTICE MAILED: **September 24, 2002**
THE APPEAL PERIOD EXPIRES (15 DAYS) AT 5 PM: **October 9, 2002**
Appeal must be filed with City Clerk by this date.

TO APPEAL THIS MATTER:
Pursuant to Section 3.24.300 of the Landmarks Preservation Ordinance: "An appeal may be taken to the City Council by the City Council on its own motion, by motion of the Planning Commission, by motion of the Civic Art Commission, by the verified application of the owners of the property or their authorized agents, or by the verified application of at least fifty residents of the City aggrieved or affected by any determination of the commission made under the provisions of this chapter". Any appeal submitted by the public must be in writing, specifying the reasons for the appeal. The appeal fee is $64.00. The City Clerk's Department is located on the first floor at 2180 Milvia Street, Berkeley, CA 94704; Phone (510) 981-6900.

NOTICE CONCERNING YOUR LEGAL RIGHTS:
If you object to a decision by the Landmarks Preservation Commission to approve or deny a Landmark or Structure of Merit Designation, the following requirements and restrictions apply:

1. You must appeal to the City Council within 15 days after the Notice of Decision of the action of the Landmarks Preservation Commission is mailed. It is your obligation to inquire with the Current Planning Division (981-7410) to determine when a Notice of Decision is mailed.
2. No lawsuit challenging a City decision to deny or approve a Landmark or Structure of Merit Designation (Code Civ. Proc. Section 1094.6(b) may be filed more than 90 days after the date the decision becomes final, as defined in Code of Civil Procedure Section 1094.6(b). Any lawsuit not filed within that 90-day period will be barred.
3. In any lawsuit that may be filed against a City Council decision to approve or deny a Landmark or Structure of Merit Designation, the issues and evidence will be limited to those raised by you or someone else, orally or in writing, at a public hearing or prior to the close of the last public hearing on the project.
4. If you believe that this decision or any condition attached to it denies you any reasonable economic use of the subject property, was not sufficiently related to a legitimate public purpose, was not sufficiently proportional to any impact of the project, or for any other reason constitutes a "taking" of property for public use without just compensation under the California or United States Constitutions, the following requirements apply:
   a. That this belief is a basis of your appeal.
   b. Why you believe that the decision or condition constitutes a "taking" of property as set forth above.
   c. All evidence and argument in support of your belief that the decision or condition constitutes a "taking" as set forth above.

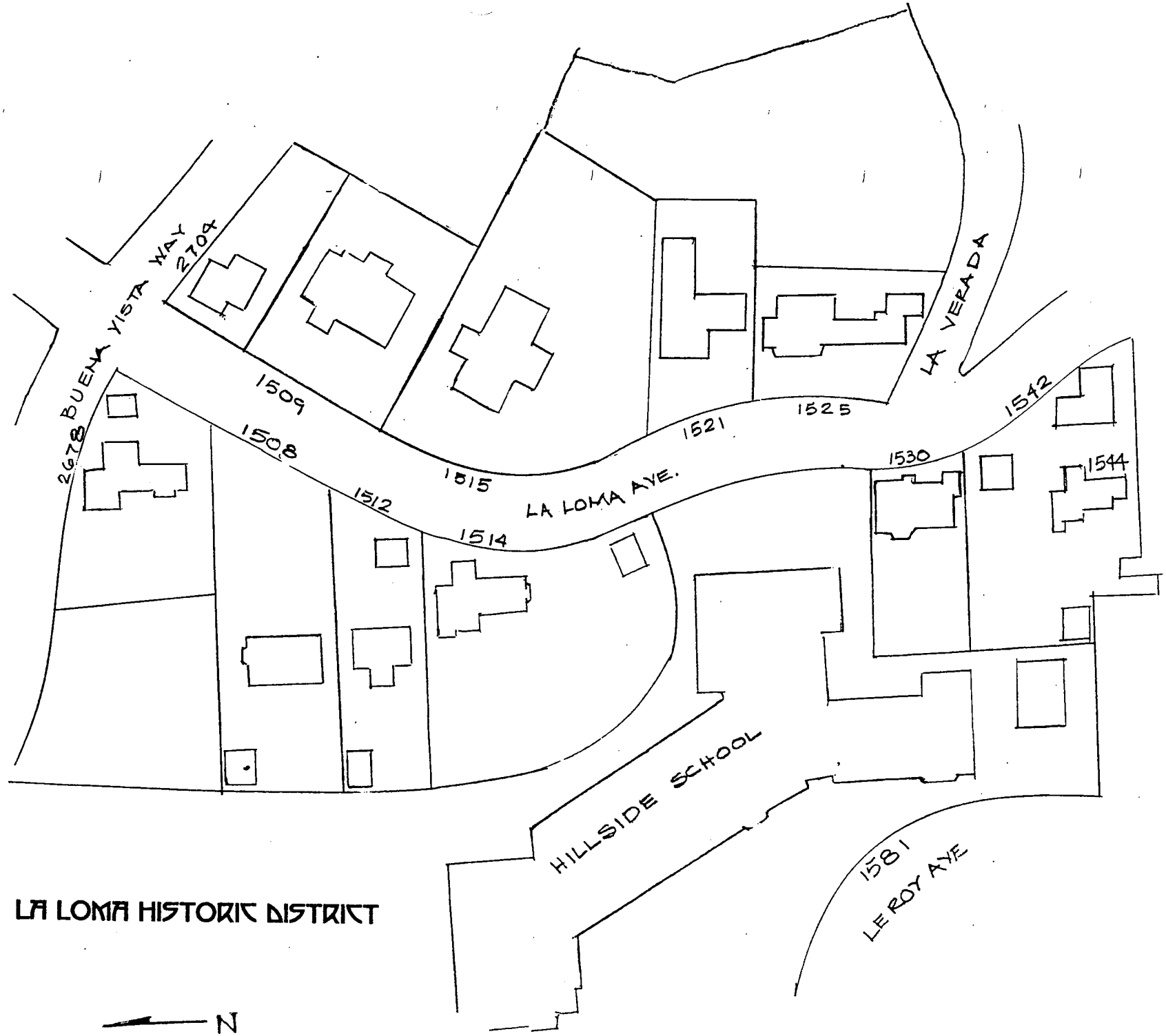
If you do not do so, you will waive any legal right to claim that your property has been taken, both before the City Council and in court.

ATTEST: 

Greg Powell
Secretary, Landmarks Preservation Commission

c:

City Clerk's Office 2180 Milvia Street Berkeley, CA 94704	Katherine Bishop Dunlap 2105 Ames Street Los Angeles, CA 90027	Ivan and Maris Meyerson 1509 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708
Helen Christensen 1514 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	Nancy and Tom Genn 1515 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	Beth Simmons and Bruce Jackan 1521 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708
William and Beverly Bouwsma 1530 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	David Bigham and Howard Arendtson 1544 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	Tamar Sanbor 2678 Buena Vista Way Berkeley, CA 94708
Berkeley Unified School District 2134 Martin Luther King Jr. Way Berkeley, CA 94704	Bruce Brubaker 311 East Richmond Avenue Point Richmond, CA 94801	Monica Rohrer 916 Oxford Street Berkeley, CA 94707
Louise Anderson 1512 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	Kenton and Kuniko King 1525 La Loma Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	Thomas Smith 2704 Buena Vista Way Berkeley, CA 94708
Sally Wages 684 Hilldale Avenue Berkeley, CA 94708	Sarah P. Knight 972 Creston Road Berkeley, CA 94708	



LA LOMA HISTORIC DISTRICT

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PROPOSAL FOR LA LOMA PARK HISTORIC DISTRICT

We propose that the thirteen properties on both sides of the block of La Loma between Buena Vista Way and La Vereda, including 1542 and 1544 on the west, be designated an Historic District. We suggest that it be called "La Loma Park" because these propoerties are located in what was originally Captain Richard Parks Thomas' 32-acre farm of that name.[1] These properties fulfill the Historic Designation requirement of unity of location as they are all contiguous. They also fulfill the requirement of support for the designation by the majority of present owners.

Furthermore, these properties as a group represent a major aspect of Berkeley's social history. Complementing the Delaware Street Historical District, which preserves an early commercial Town neighborhood, this block of La Loma represents the Gown component of Berkeley society. It has consistently been a preferred site for the residences of academics, including nationally famous figures beginning with the geologist, Andrew Lawson (1861-1952) the discoverer of the San Andreas fault; the pioneer woman scientist, Dr. Katharine Bishop (1889-1975), the co-discoverer of Vitamin E; and Alexander Meiklejohn (1872-1964), the well-known advocate of freedom of speech as the guarantor of democratic government.

In our view, however, the most important reason why this block should be designated an Historic District is its significance for Berkeley's architectural history. Nearly all of these thirteen buildings were designed by major architects--Bernard Maybeck (1864-1954), Ernest Coxhead (1863-1933), John Ballantine (1894-1969), Walter H.Ratcliff Jr. (1881-1973), Warren Perry (1884-1980), Roland Irving Stringham (1892-1954),and Oskar Gerson (1886-1966). Six of them have already been listed on neighborhood, state, and national registers. Even more important, however, is that the group of houses on this one block, constructed between 1908 and 1940, provides a time capsule of the main currents in Berkeley architecture of that period. The range of different styles reflects the spirit of creative, revolutionary experiment which inspired Berkeley architects in the first half of the twentieth century.

The history of continuous architectural experiment on this block of La Loma began in 1908 with the Lawson house at 1515 La Loma. Andrew Lawson was an eminent Canadian geologist, recruited by the young University of California to develop the department of geology. After the 1906 San Francisco earthquake he was called upon to chair a special State of California commission to study its effects. Not surprisingly, when he commissioned Bernard Maybeck to build his La Loma house he required that it be earthquake proof. To do so, Maybeck diverged from his preferred material, wood, and

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[1] On Richard Parks Thomas (1826-1900), prominent industrialist of the San Francisco Bay area, founder of the Berkeley Standard Soap Company factory and the Berkeley Ferry, see Carl Wilson, "Berkeley Historical Society: Nut Hill,' *Berkeley Voice,* May 23, 1984; June 6, 1984. Captain Thomas's La Loma Park farm was bounded by Cedar Street on the south, Rose Street on the north, LeRoy on the west, and the Berkeley Water Company property on the east just above the present Buena Vista Way.

experimented with the new construction material of re-enforced concrete. In adjusting to the requirements of this material Maybeck adapted the contemporary European architectural style of the Secession,[2] which took its name from the society of revolutionary artists and architects who had seceded from the Viennese artistic establishment.With its rejection of traditional ornament, smooth surfaces, and rhythmic arrangement of simple geometric volumes, Viennese Secession architecture was a pre-cursor of the International Style modern architecture of the 1920s.

Interestingly, 1521 La Loma, the last house built on the block, also exemplifies the values of International Style modern. In 1940 Mrs. Fritz Walton, a German emigrant, gave the commission for the house to Oskar Gerson, who had been a member of the prominent architectural firm which designed modern skyscrapers for downtown Hamburg in the 1920s. In 1940, Gerson, barred from work in Nazi Germany had justtaken refuge in California.

While these two houses illustrate an early and a late phase of the development of International Style modern, the other houses on this block of La Loma reflect in different degrees a distinctive Berkeley approach to the revolution in architecture sweeping across Europe and America. This approach was rooted in the architectural philosophy articulated by the Berkeley resident, poet, and naturalist, Charles Keeler (1871-1937). He energetically advocated his concept of the Simple Home in lectures and publications as well as by helping to organize special interest clubs, of which the Hillside Club of Berkeley residents was the most politically influential. In 1904 the Hillside Club published the main statement of his philosophy, *The Simple Home.* The Mathewson house at 2704 Buena Vista Way, designed by Maybeck in 1915, is virtually a textbook illustration of Keeler's architectural theories, but they are reflected as well in the block as a whole and in most of the individual buildings.

Keeler's theory of the Simple Home was an amalagam of the ideas of John Ruskin, William Morris, the English Arts and Crafts movement, and those of the Swedenborgian minister and amateur architect, Joseph Worcester (1836-1913). In the winter of 1877-78 Worcester had built himself a redwood shingled cottage on top of a hill in Piedmont (still extant, though altered at 575 Blair Ave.), where he entertained a circle of friends which eventually included Keeler, Maybeck, John Muir, and the painter William Keith. Their discussions, and Worcester's cottage itself, became the basis of Keeler's theory of The Simple Home. The architecture which this group inspired is known as the first phase of a San Francsco Bay region architectural tradition. One of the group's main starting points was their rejection of the contemporary urban life-style. Keeler argued that a man should spend less time working to support this costly, ostentatious life-style and should adopt a simpler way of living which would give him more time to enjoy nature, the arts, and his family. On this basis, he repudiated the elaborately decorated, painted wooden Victorian houses then popular. Since wood was the least expensive building material, he

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[2] The English architectural history authority, Sir Nikolaus Pevsner, associated the Lawson house with the Viennese Secession style on a visit to Berkeley in 19?*

recommended its use, but, following the precedent of Worcester's cottage, he felt that the wood should not be painted but should be left to weather naturally. For exterior ornament he proposed the use of trellises covered with flowering vines as at Worcester's cottage. In the interior, again following the Worcester model, he recommended simple wooden walls and the exposure of the construction so that the artistry of the craftsmanship could be appreciated. The rhythm of the structural elements would provide the basis for the decoration of the interior. Much as he admired the Worcester cottage, especially its wide rof overhangs, Keeler did not recommend it exclusively as a model for architectural style. Rather, he urged architects to look for models from pre-industrial Europe and from vernacular architecture around the world, including Japanese, "Swiss chalets, old English, old Nuremberg, old Italian, and old Spanish houses."[3]

The other basis of Keeler's and the Hillside Club's philosophy was a love of nature, especially the Bay area hills. They felt that houses should not detract from the beauty of the hills but should fit into them. Two applications of this principle are illustrated on La Loma between Buena Vista and La Vereda. When the area north of the Campus became available for city development, the Hillside Club won approval for a street system which conformed to the curving contour lines of the hillsides rather than the grid used in the flat, western section of Berkeley. To this day La Loma between Cedar and Buena Vista follows the S-curve of the hillside's contours, providing superb western and southern views for the residences. Although the street was somewhat widened and straightened in 1960, it retains the distinctive rustic character envisioned by the Hillside Club, including the pink-tinted cement sidewalks planned by Maybeck.

The second way in which the ideal of fitting buildings into the natural environment is illustrated on La Loma in the irregular siting of the houses in relation to the street. Keeler had argued that, rather than being sited in accordance with a standardized distance from the street, a house should be located on its lot to take advantage of the light, view, and natural beauty of the site. The siting of the Lawson house is a prime example of the application of this concept. The long rectangular building repeats the projecting line of the hillside. Gardens surround it on the short western and eastern ends and the long southern view-side. The main reception rooms and bedrooms with large expanses of window open onto the gardens and views, while the utilitarian driveway and interior spaces--kitchen, baths, stairs--are located on the sun-less and view-less north side.

While the first and last houses on the block exemplify International Style modern and the Mathewson house exemplifies Keeler's theoy of the Simple Home, the other ten properties reflect main currents in architectural experimentation in the Bay area in the 1920s, for they were all built between 1922 and 1930. By 1922, a new generation of architects and clients wanted

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[3] Charles Keeler, *Hillside Club Suggestions for Berkeley Homes*, Hillside Club pamphlet, 1905, p. 3, cited by Dimitri Shipounoff in his "Introduction," to Charles Keeler, *The Simple Home*, Santa Barbara, Peregrine Smith, 1979, p. xv. and n.9.

something different from brown shingles. After the disastrous fire of September 17, 1923, stucco and other retardant materials replaced wood for exterior use. Keeler's philosophy no longer dominated but nonetheless remained influential in many ways. In fact, the architectural models these designers explored were the ones he and the Worcester group had favored. The majority of the buildings represent variations on the English Arts and Crafts revival of early English architectural types the Etcheverry house at 2678 Buena Vista and the Ballantine house at 1512 La Loma have the steep roofs and upretentious scale of English cottages; the Wells-Michaeljohn house at 1525 La Loma, the Rowell house at 1509 La Loma, and the Hillside School have the high, steep, gable roofs, massive chimneys, irregular window spacing, and imposing scale of the English architects' revival of Tudor. The Tolman cottages at 1542 and 1544 and the Weeks house at 1514 with their half-timbering and colored plaster may have their origins in medieval German, or "old Nuremburg" architecture. The symmetrical Bishop house (1508) has "old Italian" echoes, while the Tolman house (1530) evokes "old Spanish.". Many of these houses, in all styles, have the deep eaves, pergolas, and trellises which appealed to Keeler. Keeler's advocacy of sleeping porches as a way of getting "close to nature" is reflected in the sleeping porch of the Bishop house, which follows the precedent of the Lawson sleeping porches across the street.

In sum, the buildings on the block of La Loma between Buena Vista Way and La Vereda illustrate Berkeley's chief experiments in architecture between 1908 and 1940--from the International Style modern, Charles Keeler's philosophy of the Simple Home to the variations of Tudor and Mediterranean revival styles of the twenties. They fulfill the requirement for a designation as an Historic District of the support of the majority of the owners, contiguity of location and time period, and a common innovative approach to design.

April 3, 2002

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